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Such a discussion is still going on and there’s no rabbit in our hats. All I can say is that none of the phenomena I am going to describe exists anymore, at least not in Italy and certainly not in its original form.

As a matter of fact, the only “white overalls” one sees on TV or on the papers these days are related to anthrax and biological warfare.

On the other hand, we are not starting

over: there can be no doubt that the multitudes of people who have challenged global capitalism all around the planet are still willing to do it. Last Sunday, more than 200,000 thousands people demonstrated in Perugia, Italy, against the US bombings of Afghanistan. Tens of thousands of people did the same here in Germany. The more “collateral damage” the Empire causes on Afghanistan, the less people are willing to accept excuses.

I know, it is harder than ever, but only fools thought it would be easy.

People who are not aware of the peculiar use we, the Italian movement, have been attributing to such words as “myth” and “myth-making” may suspect that this is a mere revival of Georges Sorel’s thought and his descriptions of the revolutionary syndicalists’ “general strike”.

As a matter of fact we have tried to keep all that was useful in Sorel’s discourse while getting rid of the most out-dated and dangerous elements.

According to Sorel, the general strike was an image that allowed proletarians to “always picture their coming action as a battle in which their cause is certain to triumph”. Such an image, or rather such a group of images, was not to be analyzed “in the way that we analyze a thing into its elements”, indeed, it must be “taken as a whole” as an “historical force”, with no comparison “between accomplished fact and the picture people [have] formed for themselves before action” (Letter to Daniel Halevy, 1908). In plain words, the social myth of the general strike was “capable of evoking instinctively all the feelings which correspond to the different manifestations of the war undertaken by Socialism against modern society”. The general strike grouped all those feelings “in a co-ordinated picture, and, by bringing them together, [gave] to each one of them its maximum of intensity [...] We thus obtain an intuition of Socialism which lan-

It has become a trivial remark, even a ridiculous one, indeed, it is being made by all and sundry: in the aftermath of the demolition of the WTC and the imperial war on Afghanistan, with the amount of “collateral damages” increasing out of sight, we all have entered a new phase of social life and conflict.

This phase is heavily affected by paranoia, war propaganda, will to censorship, restriction of such civil rights as free speech, re-embellished McCarthyism and angry mobs demanding new berufsverbote in the sinister light of the rhetoric on the “clash of civilizations”.

Back to the home front. Another Cold War. The Empire asks for it.

However, the events of September 11th have “only” made more apparent and explicit the fact that after Genoa we had entered a catastrophic realm already.

By “catastrophe” I don’t mean the end of the world, but a new topology, a space created by an abrupt discontinuity.

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